CITES

The Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species (CITES) of wild fauna and flora, also known as the Washington Convention, is a multilateral treaty to protect endangered plants and animals. It was drafted from a resolution adopted from a meeting of members of the IUCN in 1963 and opened for signature in 1973. It came into force during July 1975.

ZOOLOGICAL SURVEY OF INDIA

The Zoological Survey of India (ZSI) was established in 1916 to promote survey, exploration and research leading to the advancement in our knowledge of various aspects of biodiversity of our country.

The objectives of ZSI are:

- Exploration, Survey, Inventorying and Monitoring of faunal diversity in various states, ecosystems and protected areas of India.
- Periodic review of the status of threatened and endemic species.
- Preparation of Red Data Book and Fauna of India.
- Biological studies on selected important species.
- Maintenance and Development of National Zoological Collections.

It aims to ensure that international trade in specimens of wild animals and plants should not be a threat to the survival of the species in the wild. It accords varying degrees of protection to more than 35,0000 species of animals and plants.

12.8 Restoration of Degraded Habitats

Biodiversity conservation through eco development – an Indian case study

The Forestry Research Education and Extension Project FREEP (A World Bank Initiative) in India is employing a strategy called 'ecodevelopment' which enlists local communities in the preservation of biodiversity. The strategy involves developing alternate resources and sources of income for those who depend on the protected natural habitat (forest) for their livelihood.

FREEP is conducting pilot ecodevelopment programmes in the Kalakad-Mundanthurai Tiger Reserve (KMTR) in Tamil Nadu. The reserve contains a unique and varied array of flora ranging from thorn and dry teak to tropical evergreen, and supports a rich variety of birds and mammals, including tigers, leopards and elephants. The last tiger refuge in Tamil Nadu, the KMTR is one of 50 sites covered under the Indian Government's Project Tiger, a programme receiving international assistance to enhance tiger habitat.

CONVENTION ON BIOLOGICAL DIVERSITY (CBD)

The United Nations convention on Biological Diversity, known as CBD in short, was signed by India and 172 other nations on December 29, 1993. The CBD was an attempt to establish an international program for conserving and using the world's biological resources. This historical treaty recognizes the "sovereign right of nation over their genetic resources" and considers "appropriate access to genetic resources." The treaty also takes into account the "fair and equitable sharing" of benefits arising from the use of genetic resources.

Over 100 villages are now participating in the KMTR project. Communities and individual farmers have planted fuelwood and fodder plantations. Some villagers have installed cow dung-based gas plants for home fuel needs and are using fuel-saving pressure cookers and more efficient wood-burning stoves (smokeless chulas). Loans for a wide array of alternative income-generating activities such as dairy and poultry farming, tailoring, coconut leaf weaving, and setting up tea and dry goods shops are made

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